Personal Attachment Mapping

Saturday, July 27th, 2024
with Dr. Scott Lyons

AGENDA

Opening Practices: Grounding, Embodying Container, Filling Presence

Attachment Foundations

Archetypes and Mapping

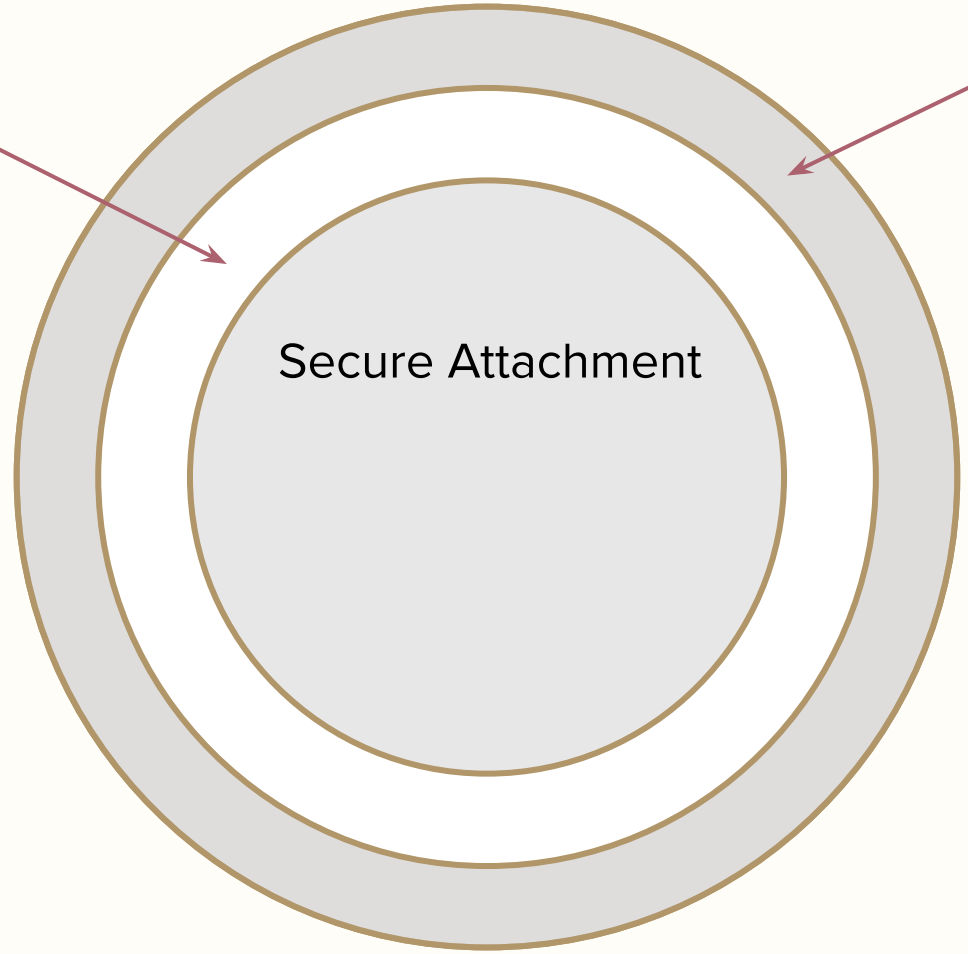
What is Attachment

The way in which a person forms / reconnects to intimate bonds with themselves (embodiment), with other people, and the environment. These bonds form the supportive foundation to be adaptive, learn and grow from new experiences, and flourish in one's goals and relationships.

Attachment Ingredients Map

Contributing
Ingredients & Factors

- Presence
- Consistency
- Co-Regulation
- Attunement
- Emotional
- Responsiveness
- Receptivity
- Expressiveness
- Support
- Safety
- Curiosity
- Compassion
- Persistence
- Reliability
- Trust



Interruptions to Bonding

- Intergenerational Trauma
- Boundary Ruptures
- Quality/Quantity of Touch
- Lack of Resources (i.e. financial, attentional, supportive)
- Structurally Harmful Systems and Inequity
- Intrusive Environments
- Over/Under Stimulation
- Unmetabolized Trauma
- Unprocessed or unhonored loss and grief
- Neglect
- Personal/Collective Disconnection and Disembodiment

Secure Attachment

Caregiver:

- Co-Regulated
- Consistent
- Present, Attuned, and Emotionally Responsive
- Receptive and Expressive

Infant feels safe, secure, seen, heard, and supported to authentically express. Baby is curious and explores.

Highly correlated with self-esteem, social competence, self-control, empathy, ego-resilience, and positive affect. Such adults tend to be attentive, social, cooperative and able to give and accept care.

Insecure- Anxious

Caregiver may be:

- Often misattuned
- Inconsistent / Unpredictable
- Emotionally (expressive) unavailable

Infant has distress when a caregiver leaves and difficult to soothe when they return.

People with an insecure-anxious attached people have an over-responsive nervous system, and harder to soothe and stop impulses, and concerns about others availability. Negative self image of self and positive of others. High bar of connection.

Insecure-Avoidant

Caregiver may be:

- Impatient
- Unresponsive
- Too much stimulation

Infant interacts very little with caregiver, shows little distress when they leaves the room and avoids / ignores upon their return.

People with insecure-avoidant attached stance have an under-responsive nervous system, and shut down, run away and minimize their needs. They suppress emotions to protect from vulnerability. They downplay the importance of relationships, avoid connection, and appear extremely self-reliant. They view others as not providing safety or comfort.

Insecure- Disorganized/ Fearful/ Disoriented

Caregiver may have:

- Neglect
- Abuse

Infant exhibits confusion or fear in the presence of caregiver .

Those who are Insecure-fearful strongly fear rejection and become dependent in relationships. They tend to have more freeze in their nervous system and have a propensity for dissociation. They are in a tug-of-war between wanting intimacy and fearing it. They often experienced mixed messages from caregivers such as “Come closer” and “Go away!” They often view both themselves and others in a negative perspective.

Attachment Patterns/ Energetic Archetypes

- Leave
- Hyper-Connect
- Hide
- Retracting / Shrinking
- Fighting
- Rigid
- Chasing / Over- Extending / Grasping
- Merging
- Fixation
- Spilling / Leaking
- Logical

Identifying Patterns

What changes in / Or what is the habit in:

- Grounding/ Anchoring
- Containment
- Filling / Presence
- Focus / Attention
- Energy
- Emotions
- Body shaping / Muscular / Soma (i.e breath)

BREAKOUT SESSIONS

Relational Blueprints Practice

1) What makes you feel safe (enough) and loved
    a) From yourself
    b) From others
    c) From the environment

Relational Blueprints Practice

1) Draw out the relational patterns of your immediate family
2) What beliefs did you form about relationships and love as you grew up, based on your surroundings (were they positive and constructive, or damaging?)

Relational Blueprints Practice

1) What worked? What are some things that you really liked that they did?
2) What didn't work? What are some things that you really couldn't stand?
3) What are some of the mistakes your partner made? What are some that you may have made?
4) What is the somatic response as you attune to that person?
5) What is the somatic response as you attune to that relationship?
6) What was energetic archetype / attachment strategies that emerged in this relation dynamic?
7) What skills did I gain from this relationship? What did I learn about myself from this relationship.

QUESTIONS

BREAKOUT SESSIONS

Discussion Prompts

1. What did you discover in terms of your own patterns / energetic archetypes?

2. What allowed you to begin to see patterns in other people?